

Install Obsidian on Mac

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Before you begin

Obsidian is free to download and use. You do not need an account for the app. Your vault is an ordinary folder on your Mac.

Install

1. Go to <https://obsidian.md/download>.
2. Under Mac, select Universal.
3. Open the downloaded installation file.
4. Drag Obsidian into the Applications folder.
5. Open Applications, then open Obsidian. If macOS asks whether to open it, confirm.

Create your first vault

6. Choose Create new vault.
7. Name it Genealogy Research.
8. Choose a location you can find again, such as Documents.
9. Select Create.

Find the files later

In Finder, open the folder you chose. Every note is a plain .md text file. PDFs and images can live in the same vault.

Recommended for the workshop: keep the vault local first. Add syncing only after the basic workflow feels comfortable.

Sync and backup

- Obsidian Sync is optional: Standard is \$4/month billed annually or \$5 monthly; Plus is \$8/\$10.
- iCloud Drive can work for Apple-only use, but keep files downloaded locally and allow syncing to finish before switching devices.
- Do not run Obsidian Sync and another sync service on the same vault.
- Sync is not a backup. Keep a separate backup copy.

Official sources

obsidian.md/help/install • obsidian.md/pricing • obsidian.md/help/sync